Impartial Analysis of Measure Q from Diamond Bar City Attorney

Measure Q, the "Diamond Bar Local Control, City Services Measure" seeks voter approval at the November 3, 2026, General Election of an ordinance enacting a one cent (1%) transactions and use tax locally in the City of Diamond Bar. A "transactions and use tax" is commonly known as a "sales tax." Sales taxes are not a tax on homes or properties. Sales taxes are applied to purchases of certain goods and services (except for food purchased as groceries, prescription medication, medical and dental services, professional services, utilities and educational expenses). Out of town shoppers visiting Diamond Bar will also share in the cost.

This sales tax would be a general tax, meaning that revenues raised from the tax would go into the City's general fund and may be used for general governmental purposes of the City, including emergency response, Sheriff protection, keeping public areas safe and clean, preventing property crimes and burglaries, projects to minimize the risk of wildfires and to respond to them or other natural disasters, maintain and repair roads and prevent potholes, address homelessness and other City services. The measure is intended to prevent significant cuts to general City services such as those mentioned above, resulting from revenue shortfalls caused by recent economic factors, including increased costs of providing public safety, labor, insurance, utilities, maintenance and contracted services that continue to rise faster than revenues.

If approved by a majority of the voters, the tax would be paid in addition to current sales taxes and would be collected at the same time and in the same manner as existing sales taxes. By law, all revenues raised by the measure would belong to the City of Diamond Bar and could not be taken by, or shared with, the State or any other agency. If approved, the measure would impose a City tax that would add one cent to the cost of a one-dollar item purchased in Diamond Bar. The City estimates that the proposed sales tax will generate an additional six million dollars annually, but the actual amounts raised will vary based on the level of retail sales occurring in Diamond Bar.

The measure requires annual audits to review and report on the revenue and expenditure from funds raised by the measure.

A "yes" vote on Measure Q will authorize the one cent (1%) sales tax.

A "no" vote on Measure Q will not authorize the sales tax.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of the measure or proposed ordinance. If you desire a copy of the measure or the ordinance, please call the City Clerk's office at (909) 839-7010 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you. It is also available as a attachment to the staff report regarding the measure on the City Council agenda for July 21, 2026, item 9.1, available on the City's website, https://www.diamondbarca.gov/293/City-Meetings.

s/Omar Sandoval
City Attorney